Introduction to Agentic AI

AI that Thinks, Plans, and Acts

Traditional AI vs Agentic AI

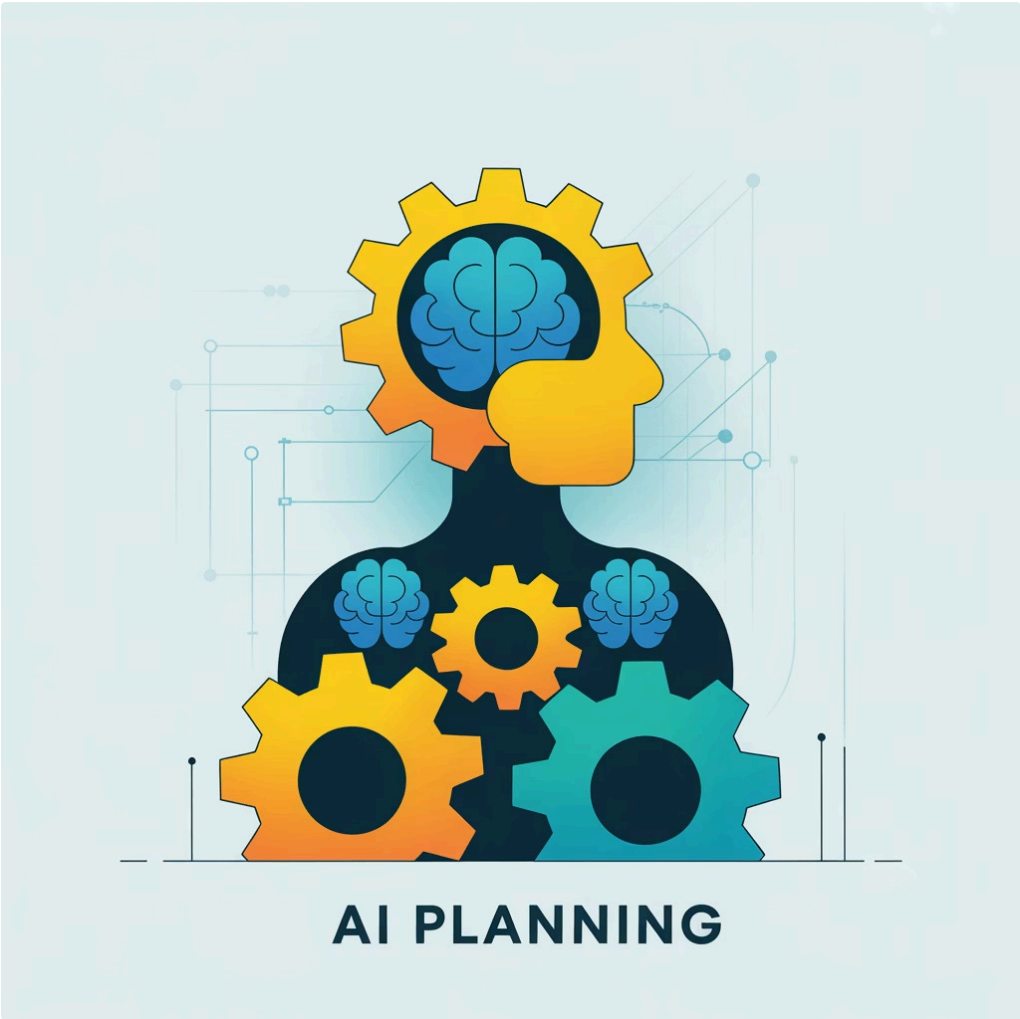
Traditional AI

Predict & Respond

- Waits for human input
- Provides single responses
- Limited to trained patterns
- Reactive by design

Like a calculator that waits for your questions

Agentic AI



Think, Plan & Act

- Sets its own goals
- Creates multi-step plans
- Adapts to new situations
- Proactive and autonomous

Like a smart assistant that anticipates your needs

Why Agentic AI Matters for Business

Agentic AI is transforming how organizations operate by taking over complex, multi-step processes that traditionally required human oversight. This technology doesn't just respond to commands—it understands context, makes decisions, and executes complete workflows autonomously.

Automates Complex Tasks

Handles entire workflows from start to finish, not just single actions. Can manage customer inquiries, process applications, and coordinate between systems without human intervention.

Works Across Industries

HR departments use it for candidate screening and onboarding. Finance teams deploy it for invoice processing and compliance. Customer support leverages it for complex problem resolution.

Frees Human Potential

Eliminates repetitive, time-consuming tasks so employees can focus on strategic thinking, creative problem-solving, and relationship building—the uniquely human skills that drive business growth.

Essential Agentic AI Terms

Understanding these key concepts will help you navigate the world of agentic AI and communicate effectively with technical teams and vendors.

Agent

An autonomous AI system that can perceive its environment, make decisions, and take actions to achieve specific goals. Think of it as a digital employee with specialized skills.

Action

Specific tasks or operations an agent can perform, such as sending emails, updating databases, or analyzing documents. Actions are the building blocks of agent capabilities.

Orchestrator

The central system that coordinates multiple agents and their actions, ensuring they work together efficiently toward common business objectives.

Multi-Agent System

Multiple specialized agents working collaboratively, each contributing their unique skills to solve complex business challenges that require diverse expertise.

Guardrails

Safety mechanisms and rules that prevent agents from taking inappropriate actions, ensuring they operate within acceptable business and ethical boundaries.